

Document 17: Drug Abuse - Definition and Prevention

Drug abuse is the harmful or hazardous use of psychoactive substances, including alcohol and illicit drugs. It can lead to addiction, health complications, social problems, and legal issues. Commonly abused substances include opioids, stimulants, hallucinogens, and alcohol. Prevention strategies focus on education, early intervention, counseling, and community-based programs. Treatment may involve behavioral therapy, medication-assisted treatment, and support groups. Reducing stigma and providing access to mental health services are crucial for effective prevention and recovery.